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Forward Deployed Engineer
sync. — Y Combinator (W24)
Hyderabad, India

Dear sync. Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Forward Deployed Engineer role at sync. I recently completed my B.E. in Information Technology from MVSR Engineering College in Hyderabad, and I am drawn to roles where technical depth meets real-world delivery — adapting AI systems to solve concrete problems for partners who depend on reliable outputs. sync.'s mission to make video as fluid and editable as a document, built on the team's Wav2Lip legacy, is exactly the kind of ambitious, science-meets-production challenge I want to grow into.

At **Samyama.ai**, I worked as an SDE intern building and fine-tuning a domain-specific Small Language Model in Python. I experimented with model behavior across training iterations, curated and validated a 35,506-record dataset for schema compliance, and evaluated latency-versus-cost trade-offs between SLM and generic LLM architectures. This taught me how model adaptation requires disciplined experimentation — tuning behavior for specific use cases while keeping production constraints in mind.

My major project, *Bridging Learning Gaps*, is a live **video processing system** I built end-to-end: OpenCV and MediaPipe for real-time video capture, a CNN-LSTM deep learning model for gesture recognition (93.7% accuracy), and Flask for deployment from input through inference to output. While this is sign-language recognition rather than lip-sync, the workflow — adapting a trained model to a specific video use case and shipping a reliable pipeline — mirrors the hands-on experimentation and workflow design your FDE role describes.

At **CloudSire Solutions**, I worked as an Integration Engineer designing repeatable workflows across Salesforce, Jira, Mailchimp, ServiceNow, Slack, and Outlook. I regularly translated ambiguous business requirements into reliable automated pipelines, debugged end-to-end data flows, and iterated with cross-functional stakeholders when production behavior needed refinement. This is the closest experience I have to embedded technical delivery: understanding what a partner needs, building a system that works, and improving it based on feedback.

In **Poditivity's Founder's Office**, I coordinated cross-functional teams in an early-stage startup and communicated technical and business insights to leadership — strengthening my ability to work across engineering and non-technical boundaries under ambiguity.

I want to be direct about where I am still growing. I do not yet have experience deploying models for external studio or creative partners in a true forward-deployed setting, and I have not worked with **PyTorch** or **Kubernetes** in production. My deep learning work spans Transformers-based SLM fine-tuning and CNN-LSTM video models, not audio-visual lip-sync specifically. What I bring is genuine curiosity about computer vision, proven ability to experiment with models and ship video pipelines, workflow design discipline from integration engineering, and the willingness to learn quickly alongside sync.'s team and partners.

I am based in **Hyderabad** and am fully available for on-site, hybrid, or remote work as the role requires. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to sync.'s production deployments while growing into the partner-facing delivery the role demands.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to discussing how my Python, deep learning, and workflow experience can support sync.'s mission.

Sincerely,
Sankeerth Masetty